CONFOEDERATIO,
RESEARCH DIVISION (CRD).

DEMOGRAPHY AND SETTLEMENT OF LATE IMPERIAL RUSSIA (1815AD - 1917AD).

A Regional Literature Review of Population and Settlement (1815AD - 1917AD).

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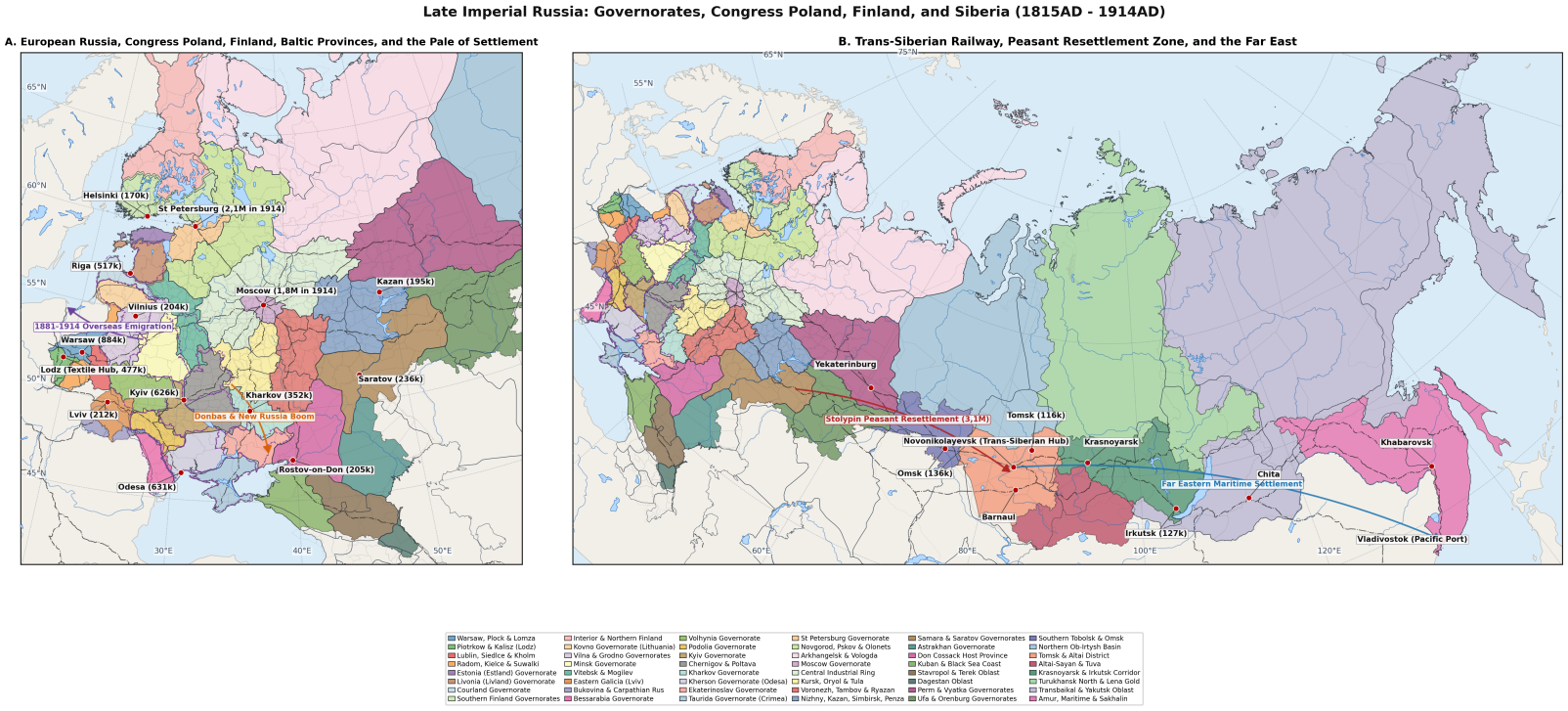


Figure 1. Governorates, oblasts, crownlands, railways, and major urban centres of Late Imperial Russia and Austro-Hungarian Ukraine (1815AD - 1917AD).

Population Series and 48-Region Partition (1815AD - 1917AD)

Between the Final Act of the Congress of Vienna in June 1815AD and the collapse of the Romanov monarchy in 1917AD, the population across the 48 period-authentic Governorates (*Guberniyas*), Oblasts, Finnish Provinces, Vistula Provinces, and Austro-Hungarian Ukrainian Crownlands covering 18 607 231 km2 (460 079 five-arcminute grid pixels, excluding Central Asia and the Southern Caucasus) nearly tripled. Calibrated totals rose from 57 871k (57,87M) in 1815AD to 67 360k (67,36M) at the Eighth Soul Revision in 1833AD, 78 340k (78,34M) at the Ninth Revision in 1850AD, 83 917k (83,92M) at the Tenth Revision in 1858AD, 94 583k (94,58M) in 1870AD, 110 352k (110,35M) in 1885AD, 123 885k (123,89M) at the First All-Russian Imperial Census of 28 January 1897AD, 156 225k (156,23M) in 1910AD, and a pre-war peak of 167 945k (167,95M) on 1 January 1914AD, before First World War mobilisation, combat mortality, and the 1915AD *bezhentsy* refugee evacuation lowered the regional population to 165 375k (165,38M) in 1917AD [1][2][3][4][5][6].

Retrofitting post-1991AD oblast or republic boundaries onto nineteenth-century Eastern Europe and Northern Asia conceals the legal, fiscal, and infrastructural boundaries that actually governed demographic behaviour between 1815AD and 1917AD. Six institutional divides structured the 48-region spatial framework shown in Figure 1 and tabulated in Table 1:

Separate Western Autonomous Polities Incorporated by 1809-1815AD: The Congress Kingdom of Poland (Regions 1-4, comprising all ten Vistula Governorates: Warsaw, Plock, Lomza, Piotrkow, Kalisz, Lublin, Siedlce with the 1912AD Kholm split, Radom, Kielce, and Suwalki), the three German-noble Ostsee Baltic Governorates (Regions 5-7: Estland, Livland, and Courland, where landless peasant emancipation in 1816-1819AD initiated the Empire's earliest demographic transition), and the Grand Duchy of Finland (Regions 8-9: all eight Finnish *lan* administered by the Imperial Senate in Helsingfors) operated under distinct agrarian laws, customs regimes, and statistical offices [7][8][9][10].

The Statutory Pale of Permanent Jewish Settlement (*Cherta postoyannoy evreyskoy osedlosti*): Codified in 1835AD and tightened under the May Laws of 1882AD, the Pale restricted Jewish residence to the Northwestern Krai (Regions 10-13: Kovno, Vilna, Grodno, Minsk, Vitebsk, and Mogilev), Bessarabia (Region 16), the Southwestern Krai (Regions 17-19: Volhynia, Podolia, and Kyiv), Little Russia (Region 20: Chernigov and Poltava), and Novorossiya (Regions 22-24: Kherson, Ekaterinoslav, and Taurida), alongside separate civil regulations in Congress Poland [11][12][13][14].

Dual-Monarchy Partition Inside Austro-Hungarian Ukraine: Across the southwestern border, Habsburg-ruled Ukrainian lands were divided after the 1867AD *Ausgleich* between Austrian *Cisleithania* - comprising Eastern Galicia (Region 14: Lemberg/Lviv, Tarnopol, Stanislau, and the Boryslav oil basin) and the Duchy of Bukovina (Czernowitz) - and Hungarian *Transleithania* across the Subcarpathian Comitats of Bereg, Ung, Ugocsa, and Maramaros (grouped in Region 15) [15][16][17][18].

Agrarian Overpopulation in the Black-Earth Core vs Industrialising Capitals and New Russia: Post-1861AD peasant land hunger (*malozemelye*) and the 1891-1892AD Volga-Black-Earth famine in Regions 20 and 30-32 contrasted sharply with the hyper-urbanising capitals Saint Petersburg (Region 25) and Moscow (Region 28) and the coal-iron-grain boom across Kherson, Ekaterinoslav, Taurida, and the Don Cossack Host (Regions 22-24 and 35) [19][20][21][22]. Disaggregation of the Caucasian War and 1864AD *Muhajir* Frontier: Regions 36-38 separate Kuban Oblast and the Black Sea Governorate (epicentre of the 1860-1864AD Circassian expulsion and subsequent Cossack-Slavic settlement surge) from Stavropol Governorate and Terek Oblast (Vladikavkaz, Grozny oilfields, and Vainakh-Ossetian highlands) and highland Dagestan Oblast [23][24][25][26].

Orthogonal Siberian Rail Corridors vs Northern River Trails and 1858-1860AD Priamurye: Across Regions 41-48, the dense West-East Trans-Siberian, Altai Cabinet, and Priamurye settlement corridors (Regions 41, 43, 45, and 48, which absorbed over 3,0M Stolypin peasant migrants in 1906-1914AD) are explicitly separated from the bypassed Ob-Irtysh polar river trail (Region 42), the Altai-Sayan and 1914AD Uriankhai highlands (Region 44), the Yenisei-Turukhansk and Bodaibo Lena gold basin (Region 46), and Transbaikal and Yakutsk Oblasts (Region 47) [27][28][29][30].

Region / Governorate / Oblast	Area (km2)	1815AD	1833AD	1858AD	1885AD	1897AD	1914AD	1917AD
1. Warsaw, Plock & Lomza Gubs.	35 957	1 020k	1 280k	1 620k	2 650k	3 536k	5 050k	4 420k
2. Piotrkow & Kalisz Gubs.	20 156	720k	940k	1 240k	1 980k	2 245k	3 320k	2 950k
3. Lublin & Siedlce Gubs.	27 342	780k	960k	1 180k	1 740k	1 933k	2 680k	2 080k

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Region / Governorate / Oblast	Area (km2)	1815AD	1833AD	1858AD	1885AD	1897AD	1914AD	1917AD
4. Radom, Kielce & Suwalki Gubs.	33 393	780k	950k	1 160k	1 680k	2 160k	2 600k	2 180k
5. Estland Gub.	22 637	232k	275k	312k	382k	413k	505k	515k
6. Livland Gub.	54 235	615k	735k	885k	1 185k	1 299k	1 565k	1 420k
7. Courland Gub.	27 588	418k	495k	565k	655k	674k	800k	380k
8. Southern Finland Gubs.: Nyland	114 315	590k	745k	945k	1 195k	1 425k	1 840k	1 890k
9. Interior & Northern Finland Gubs.: Vasa, Kuopio, Sankt-Michel & Uleaborg	263 819	520k	645k	815k	1 015k	1 130k	1 400k	1 430k
10. Kovno Gub.	43 910	660k	785k	965k	1 380k	1 545k	1 840k	1 320k
11. Vilna & Grodno Gubs.	85 286	1 145k	1 360k	1 650k	2 680k	3 195k	3 940k	2 880k
12. Minsk Gub. & Pripyat Polesia	91 928	920k	1 040k	1 210k	1 820k	2 148k	3 040k	2 890k
13. Vitebsk & Mogilev Gubs.	83 637	1 245k	1 410k	1 640k	2 580k	3 176k	4 020k	3 860k
14. Austro-Hungarian Eastern Galicia	46 070	2 580k	2 880k	3 360k	4 120k	4 420k	5 020k	4 450k
15. Austro-Hungarian Bukovina	24 487	770k	870k	1 030k	1 290k	1 400k	1 630k	1 500k
16. Bessarabia Gub.	47 379	385k	640k	950k	1 580k	1 935k	2 660k	2 620k
17. Volhynia Gub.	76 532	1 520k	1 680k	2 010k	2 640k	2 989k	4 120k	3 680k
18. Podolia Gub.	41 427	1 440k	1 620k	1 980k	2 650k	3 018k	3 980k	3 820k
19. Kyiv Gub.	54 181	940k	1 220k	1 780k	2 920k	3 559k	4 780k	4 840k
20. Little Russian Gubs.: Chernigov & Poltava	106 759	3 350k	3 680k	4 340k	4 880k	5 076k	6 650k	6 720k
21. Kharkov Gub.	57 378	1 100k	1 260k	1 590k	2 180k	2 492k	3 440k	3 510k
22. Kherson Gub.	75 498	620k	880k	1 380k	2 240k	2 734k	3 750k	3 780k
23. Ekaterinoslav Gub.	60 209	820k	1 040k	1 460k	1 920k	2 114k	3 450k	3 580k
24. Taurida Gub.	69 868	370k	520k	660k	1 080k	1 448k	2 060k	2 080k
25. Saint Petersburg Gub.	62 709	760k	940k	1 220k	1 760k	2 112k	3 150k	3 380k
26. Novgorod, Pskov & Olonets Gubs.	306 049	1 770k	1 960k	2 260k	2 680k	2 853k	3 580k	3 680k
27. Arkhangelsk & Vologda Gubs.	1 313 985	920k	1 040k	1 240k	1 540k	1 688k	2 220k	2 280k
28. Moscow Gub.	28 080	1 120k	1 320k	1 620k	2 140k	2 431k	3 560k	3 820k
29. Central Industrial Ring: Vladimir, Yaroslavl, Kostroma, Tver, Smolensk & Kaluga Gubs.	320 596	6 750k	7 250k	8 080k	8 820k	9 160k	11 520k	11 880k

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Region / Governorate / Oblast	Area (km2)	1815AD	1833AD	1858AD	1885AD	1897AD	1914AD	1917AD
30. Western Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Kursk, Oryol & Tula	116 196	4 520k	5 020k	5 880k	6 420k	6 207k	7 980k	8 180k
31. Eastern Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Voronezh, Tambov & Ryazan	163 112	5 120k	5 720k	6 760k	7 280k	7 037k	9 220k	9 450k
32. Middle Volga Gubs.: Nizhny Novgorod, Kazan, Simbirsk & Penza	196 693	4 280k	4 820k	5 720k	6 520k	6 755k	8 350k	8 550k
33. Samara & Saratov Gubs.	257 216	1 580k	2 180k	3 380k	4 680k	5 157k	6 880k	7 120k
34. Astrakhan Gub.	157 993	380k	480k	640k	880k	1 004k	1 380k	1 410k
35. Don Cossack Host	173 010	680k	880k	1 420k	2 120k	2 564k	3 880k	3 940k
36. Kuban Oblast & Black Sea Gub.	100 010	420k	480k	640k	1 380k	1 976k	3 060k	3 120k
37. Stavropol Gub. & Terek Oblast	131 162	545k	640k	860k	1 480k	1 807k	2 610k	2 650k
38. Dagestan Oblast	30 663	450k	440k	410k	530k	571k	715k	725k
39. Perm & Vyatka Gubs.	491 785	1 920k	2 380k	3 420k	5 180k	6 025k	7 880k	8 040k
40. Ufa & Orenburg Gubs.	339 132	1 400k	1 780k	2 560k	3 420k	3 797k	5 350k	5 480k
41. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Belt: Southern Tobolsk	244 121	545k	680k	990k	1 480k	1 740k	3 180k	3 320k
42. Ob-Irtysh River Trail & Polar Tundra: Tobolsk, Surgut, Berezov & Narym	1 637 985	160k	185k	240k	325k	375k	505k	520k
43. Tomsk Railway Trunk	499 967	300k	410k	690k	1 340k	1 928k	3 980k	4 180k
44. Altai-Sayan Highlands: Gorny Altai, Minusinsk & Uriankhai Protectorate	418 838	125k	150k	205k	285k	330k	565k	575k
45. Central Siberian Trans-Siberian Corridor: Achinsk-Krasnoyarsk-Kansk & Irkutsk	521 596	210k	260k	375k	610k	795k	1 540k	1 560k
46. Yenisei-Turukhansk Polar North & Bodaibo Lena Goldfields	2 480 545	68k	80k	110k	165k	195k	270k	265k
47. Transbaikal Oblast	6 008 677	278k	320k	415k	680k	942k	1 295k	1 305k

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Region / Governorate / Oblast	Area (km2)	1815AD	1833AD	1858AD	1885AD	1897AD	1914AD	1917AD
48. Priamurye Gov.-Gen.: Amur, Primorskaya	1 043 120	30k	35k	55k	195k	372k	1 135k	1 150k
Total (All 48 Period-Authentic Regions)	18 607 231	57 871k	67 360k	83 917k	110 352k	123 885k	167 945k	165 375k

Table 1. Regional population series in thousands and land areas across all 48 governorates, oblasts, and crownlands (1815AD - 1917AD).

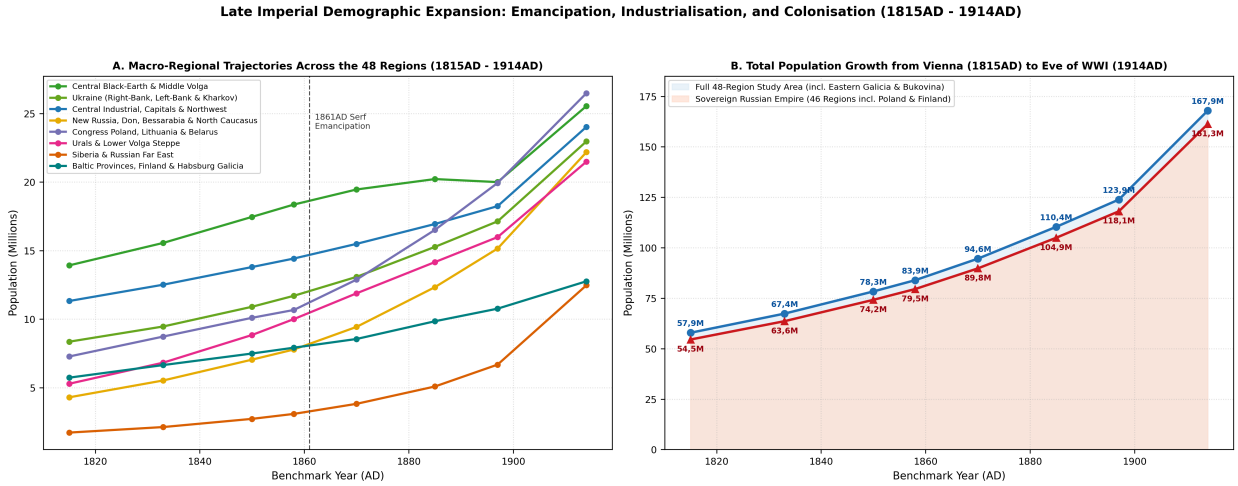


Figure 2. Macro-regional population trajectories in millions (Panel A) and indexed growth relative to 1815AD = 100 across Late Imperial Russia (Panel B).

Archive Fiscal, Statistical, and Census Sources (1815AD - 1917AD)

Reconstructing provincial populations across this 102-year period synthesises seven distinct archival and statistical series, summarised across all ten benchmark dates in Table 2:

The Final Four Soul Revisions (*Revizii*, VII-X, 1815AD - 1858AD): Following the Seventh Revision (1815-1816AD), which recorded Napoleonic wartime losses across western and central provinces, Imperial fiscal commissions conducted the Eighth (1833-1835AD), Ninth (1850AD), and Tenth (1857-1858AD) Soul Revisions [1][31][32]. Unlike the male-only Sixth Revision of 1811AD, Revisions VII-X registered both sexes of the tax-bearing estates (*podatnye sosloviya*). Following V. M. Kabuzan (1971AD, 1992AD) and A. G. Troinitsky (1861AD), raw revision returns are supplemented with Governorate statistical committee (*gubernskie statisticheskie komitety*) police registers for tax-exempt nobles, clergy, civil servants, regular military forces, and Cossack hosts [2][22][33].

Central Statistical Committee (*TsSK MVD*) Yearbooks (1863AD - 1914AD), established within the Ministry of Internal Affairs in 1858-1863AD under P. P. Semenov, the *Tsentralnyy Statisticheskiy Komitet* published periodic compilations (*Statisticheskiy vremennik Rossiyskoy imperii*) and, from 1904AD to 1915AD, annual

yearbooks (*Statisticheskiy ezhegodnik Rossii*), combining Orthodox synodal, Lutheran, Catholic, Jewish, and Muslim vital registration with *zemstvo* household censuses (*podvornye perepisi*) [3][5][34].

The First All-Russian General Census of 28 January 1897AD, directed by Semenov-Tyan-Shansky and edited by N. A. Troinitsky across 89 provincial volumes (1899-1905AD), the 1897AD Census enumerated 125 640 021 *de facto* residents across the Empire excluding Finland [4][35]. Across our 46 Russian, Polish, Baltic, Siberian, and Finnish regions, the 1897AD benchmark totals 118 065k (115 510k across the 44 Imperial and Vistula regions - matching the 1897AD Census guberniya totals minus the 10,13M inhabitants of Transcaucasia and Central Asia outside this spatial mask - plus 2 555k in the Grand Duchy of Finland), which together with 5 820k in Austro-Hungarian Galicia, Bukovina, and Subcarpathia yields the exact 48-region 1897AD anchor of 123 885k [4][15][36].

Finnish Decennial Statistical Censuses (*Tilastollinen paatoimisto*, 1815AD - 1910AD): Because the Grand Duchy of Finland retained Swedish-era Lutheran parish population registers (*kirkonkirjat* and *vaestotaulut* initiated in 1749AD) and established its own Central Statistical Office in 1865AD, Regions 8-9 possess continuous quinquennial and decennial *de jure* and *de facto* series (1 110k in 1815AD, 1 760k in 1858AD, 1 770k in 1870AD following the 1866-1868AD famine, 2 555k in 1897AD, and 3 050k in 1910AD) [36][37].

Warsaw Statistical Committee (*Varshavskiy Statisticheskiy Komitet*, 1888AD - 1914AD): For the ten Vistula Governorates (Privislinskie gubernii, Regions 1-4), civil registry books introduced under the Napoleonic Code in 1808AD and the 40 volumes of *Trudy Varshavskogo statisticheskogo komiteta* reconcile permanent (*postoyannoe*) and non-permanent industrial migrant (*nepostoyannoe*) urban populations in Warsaw, Lodz, and Sosnowiec alongside the 1897AD Census (9 874k in 1897AD; 13 650k on 1 January 1914AD) [7][38][39].

Austro-Hungarian *Volkszahlung* and Hungarian *Nepszamlalas* (1869AD - 1910AD): Regions 14-15 are anchored prior to 1857AD by Josephinian military conscription rolls and thereafter by the modern decennial censuses of the *k.k. Statistische Zentralkommission* in Vienna (1880, 1890, 1900, 1910AD) for Eastern Galicia and Bukovina and the *Magyar Kiralyi Kozponti Statisztikai Hivatal* in Budapest for Subcarpathia [15][16]. The 1916-1917AD Agricultural and Urban Censuses and Tatiana Committee Refugee Registers: Following abortive preparations for a Second Imperial Census in 1915AD [40], the Ministry of Agriculture and Provisional Government conducted the 1916AD and 1917AD All-Russian Agricultural, Land, and Urban Censuses [41][42]. Combined with the registration rolls of the Tatiana Committee and *Zemgor* analysed by Peter Gatrell (1999AD), these returns quantify the displacement of over 6,0M wartime refugees (*bezhentsy*) by early 1917AD [6][43].

Benchmark & Archive Source	Poland (1-4)	Balt.-Fin. (5-9)	Pale-Bess. (10-19*)	Habsb. (14-15)	Ukraine-Cauc. (20-24,36-38)	Heartland-Ural (25-35,39-40)	Siberia-FE (41-48)	Total (48 Regs)
1815AD (Revision VII / Vienna Act)	3 300k	2 375k	8 255k	3 350k	7 675k	31 200k	1 716k	57 871k
1833AD (Revision VIII / Parish)	4 130k	2 895k	9 755k	3 750k	8 940k	35 770k	2 120k	67 360k
1850AD (Revision IX / Conscript)	4 910k	3 337k	11 345k	4 150k	10 560k	41 320k	2 718k	78 340k
1858AD (Revision X / 1857 Habsb.)	5 200k	3 522k	12 185k	4 390k	11 340k	44 200k	3 080k	83 917k

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Benchmark & Archive Source	Poland (1-4)	Balt.-Fin. (5-9)	Pale-Bess. (10-19*)	Habsb. (14-15)	Ukraine-Cauc. (20-24,36-38)	Heartland-Ural (25-35,39-40)	Siberia-FE (41-48)	Total (48 Regs)
1870AD (TsSK / 1869 A-H / Fin.)	6 340k	3 728k	14 340k	4 820k	13 030k	48 510k	3 815k	94 583k
1885AD (TsSK / Zemstvo / VSK)	8 050k	4 432k	18 250k	5 410k	15 690k	53 440k	5 080k	110 352k
1897AD (1st Imperial Census)	9 874k	4 941k	21 565k	5 820k	18 218k	56 790k	6 677k	123 885k
1910AD (TsSK / 1910 A-H & Fin.)	12 670k	5 770k	26 740k	6 450k	23 740k	70 030k	10 825k	156 225k
1914AD (TsSK / VSK Pre-WWI Peak)	13 650k	6 110k	28 380k	6 650k	25 735k	74 950k	12 470k	167 945k
1917AD (Ag.-Urban Census / WWI)	11 630k	5 635k	25 910k	5 950k	26 165k	77 210k	12 875k	165 375k

Table 2. Complete 10-benchmark demographic series (1815AD - 1917AD, in thousands) across the seven macro-institutional blocks of the 48-region partition.

Congress Poland, the Baltic Baltic Transition, and Finland (Regions 1-9)

Congress Kingdom of Poland: Vistula Industrialisation and 1915AD *Biezenstwo* (Regions 1-4)

Created at the Congress of Vienna in 1815AD out of the Napoleonic Duchy of Warsaw and reorganised into ten Vistula Governorates in 1867AD, Congress Poland (116 848 km2 across Regions 1-4) experienced the most rapid demographic densification of any western territory in the Empire, growing more than fourfold from 3 300k in 1815AD (28,2 per km2) to 5 200k in 1858AD, 9 874k in 1897AD, and 13 650k in 1914AD (116,8 per km2) [7][38]. Whereas the November (1830-1831AD) and January (1863-1864AD) Uprisings inflicted short-term wartime casualties, confiscations, and Siberian deportations, Tsar Alexander II's Polish Emancipation Ukase of 2 March 1864AD granted freehold title to Polish, Ukrainian, and Lithuanian peasants without direct redemption payments to landlords, unleashing high rural natural increase (1,6-1,9% per year) [2][44].

Simultaneously, the abolition of the Russo-Polish customs barrier (1851AD), the completion of the Warsaw-Vienna (1848AD) and Warsaw-Saint Petersburg (1862AD) railways, and the 1877AD Imperial gold tariff turned Congress Poland into the premier textile and coal-metallurgical workshop for the Russian market [7][39][45]:

Region 1 (Warsaw, Plock & Lomza Governorates) rose from 1 020k (1815AD) to 3 536k (1897AD) and 5 050k (1914AD), anchored by Warsaw, the Empire's third metropolis (0k in 1815AD to 162,8k in 1858AD to 683,7k in 1897AD to 884,5k in 1914AD, 36,9% Jewish in 1914AD), alongside the Zyrardow linen complex (6k) and Vistula river ports Wloclawek (4k) and Plock (2k) [7][38]. Region 2 (Piotrkow & Kalisz Governorates)

surged nearly fivefold from 720k (1815AD) to 2 245k (1897AD) and 3 320k (1914AD). Designated a factory settlement in 1820AD when it held fewer than 800 inhabitants, Lodz expanded to 29,5k (1858AD), 314,0k (1897AD), and 477,9k (1914AD, over 550k with satellite mill suburbs Pabianice and Zgierz), while the Dabrowa Basin along the Silesian border transformed fishing and mining hamlets into Sosnowiec (5k in 1914AD, chartered only in 1902AD), Czestochowa (9k), and Bendzin (8k) [39][45].

Region 3 (Lublin & Siedlce Governorates) and Region 4 (Radom, Kielce & Suwalki Governorates) grew from 780k each in 1815AD to 2 680k and 2 600k in 1914AD, despite heavy peasant overseas emigration from Suwalki and Kalisz during the 1890-1913AD "Brazilian Fever" and North American steamship boom [46]. In June 1912AD, St Petersburg detached the eastern Ukrainian-Uniate *uezds* of Lublin and Siedlce to form Kholm Governorate (Chelm, 24,6k) directly subordinated to Kiev [43]. During the German-Austrian offensive of summer 1915AD, Russian military scorched-earth orders triggered the catastrophic *biezenstwo* (Great Retreat), evacuating over 2,0M residents eastward and slashing Regions 1-4 from 13 650k (1914AD) to 11 630k (1917AD), with Region 3 losing -22,4% (2 680k to 2 080k) and Kalisz shelled to ruins in August 1914AD (4k to 29,0k) [6][43].

Baltic Baltic Governorates: Early Fertility Transition and Riga's Rise (Regions 5-7)

In Estland (Region 5), Livland (Region 6), and Courland (Region 7), Alexander I's peasant emancipation acts of 1816AD (Estland), 1817AD (Courland), and 1819AD (Livland) abolished serfdom four decades before inner Russia while leaving arable land in the hands of Baltic German baronial manors (*Ritterschaften*) until mid-century tenant-purchase reforms (1849-1860s) [9][47]. Combined with near-universal Lutheran catechism literacy (92-96% adult literacy in 1897AD versus 21% Empire-wide) and a West European late-marriage pattern (*Hajnal* line), the three Baltic provinces pioneered the first sustained marital fertility transition in the Russian Empire, with Princeton European Fertility Project indices (I_g) falling by more than 10% across Estland, Livland, and Courland between the 1860s and 1880s - forty to fifty years ahead of Central Russia [8][9][48].

Consequently, natural growth across Regions 5-7 was moderate (1 265k in 1815AD -> 1 762k in 1858AD -> 2 386k in 1897AD -> 2 870k in 1914AD), while urban-industrial concentration was intense: Riga (Region 6) grew from 36,0k (1815AD) to 282,2k (1897AD) and 517,5k (1914AD) as the Empire's leading timber-export port and rubber, chemical, electrotechnical, and railcar manufacturing centre (Provodnik, Russo-Balt); Reval/Tallinn (Region 5) surged to 137,6k (1914AD) and 159,0k (1917AD) around Peter the Great's Naval Fortress shipyards; Dorpat/Tartu (48,6k) anchored Baltic scholarship; and Libau/Liepaja (Region 7, 90,7k in 1914AD) served as the ice-free home port of the Russian American Line, dispatching 40k-70k Pale and Baltic emigrants annually to New York [13][47]. In spring-summer 1915AD, the German *Niemen Army* occupied Courland (Region 7), driving half its population into interior Russia (800k in 1914AD -> 380k in 1917AD, -52,5%), while the evacuation of Riga's machinery and 300k+ factory workers and families halved Riga to 210,0k and lowered Livland (Region 6) from 1 565k to 1 420k [6].

Grand Duchy of Finland and the 1866-1868AD Great Hunger Years (Regions 8-9)

Autonomous since the Diet of Porvoo (1809AD) and enlarged by the reincorporation of Old Finland (Viipuri/Vyborg Governorate) in 1812AD, the Grand Duchy of Finland (378 134 km2 across Regions 8-9) expanded steadily from 1 110k in 1815AD (590k in coastal/southern Region 8; 520k in interior/northern Region 9) to 1 760k in 1858AD [36][49]. This pre-industrial trajectory suffered Europe's last major peacetime subsistence catastrophe during the Finnish Great Hunger Years (*Suuret nalkavuodet*, 1866-1868AD). Following wet summers and a devastating early September frost in 1867AD that destroyed rye and barley harvests across Ostrobothnia, Savo, and Kainuu while Senate Finance Head J. V. Snellman prioritized defence of the newly introduced silver *markka*, winter destitution, vagrant relief crowding, and

epidemic typhus, dysentery, and relapsing fever killed ~150k people (~8,0% of Finland's population, pushing national crude death rates to 77,6 per 1 000 in 1868AD) [10][37][50][51]. In our series, Region 9 (Vasa, Kuopio, Sankt-Michel & Uleaborg) falls directly from 815k (1858AD) to 805k (1870AD), while Region 8 (Nyland, Abo-Bjorneborg, Tavastehus & Vyborg) stagnates (945k -> 965k).

After 1870AD, completion of the Riihimaki-Saint Petersburg Railway (1870AD), dairy specialisation, and steam-sawmill, pulp, and paper industrialisation propelled Finland from 1 770k (1870AD) to 2 555k (1897AD), 3 240k (1914AD), and 3 320k (1917AD, spared frontline combat before 1918AD), led by Helsingfors/Helsinki (4,8k in 1815AD -> 84,5k in 1897AD -> 187,5k in 1917AD), Abo/Turku (54,6k), Tammerfors/Tampere (45,2k), and Viipuri/Vyborg (29,3k), even as ~300k rural Finns (above all from Vasa Governorate in Region 9) emigrated to North America between 1880AD and 1914AD [36][49].

Region (1-9)	1815AD	1850AD	1858AD	1870AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
1. Warsaw, Plock & Lomza Gubs.	1 020k	1 520k	1 620k	1 980k	3 536k	4 680k	5 050k	4 420k
2. Piotrkow & Kalisz Gubs.	720k	1 160k	1 240k	1 560k	2 245k	3 050k	3 320k	2 950k
3. Lublin & Siedlce Gubs.	780k	1 120k	1 180k	1 420k	1 933k	2 480k	2 680k	2 080k
4. Radom, Kielce & Suwalki Gubs.	780k	1 110k	1 160k	1 380k	2 160k	2 460k	2 600k	2 180k
5. Estland Gub.	232k	302k	312k	338k	413k	475k	505k	515k
6. Livland Gub.	615k	835k	885k	1 005k	1 299k	1 480k	1 565k	1 420k
7. Courland Gub.	418k	545k	565k	615k	674k	765k	800k	380k
8. Southern Finland Gubs.: Nyland	590k	890k	945k	965k	1 425k	1 720k	1 840k	1 890k
9. Interior & Northern Finland Gubs.: Vasa, Kuopio, Sankt-Michel & Uleaborg	520k	765k	815k	805k	1 130k	1 330k	1 400k	1 430k

Table 3. Population trajectories across Congress Poland, the Baltic governorates, and the Grand Duchy of Finland in thousands (1815AD - 1917AD).

The Pale of Settlement, Bessarabia, and Austro-Hungarian Ukraine (Regions 10-19)

Northwestern Krai: Lithuania, Belarus, and Shtetl Urbanisation (Regions 10-13)

Across the Lithuanian and Belarusian governorates of the Northwestern Krai (304 761 km2, Regions 10-13), total population expanded from 3 970k in 1815AD to 5 465k in 1858AD, 10 064k in 1897AD, and 12 840k in 1914AD [2][4][52][53]:

Region 10 (Kovno Governorate, created 1843AD across ethnic Samogitia/Lithuania) grew from 660k (1815AD) to 1 545k (1897AD) and 1 840k (1914AD). Intense post-1863AD Russification (including the 1864-1904AD Latin-press ban), lack of heavy industry outside Kovno/Kaunas (9k to 91,4k) and Shavli/Siauliai (5k), and early peasant parcellation triggered massive transatlantic emigration (~250k-300k ethnic Lithuanians and Litvak Jews to Pennsylvania coal mines, Chicago, Scotland, and South America in 1880-1914AD) before the 1915AD German *Ober Ost* occupation cut Kovno's population by -28,3% to 1 320k

in 1917AD [6][13][54].

Region 11 (Vilna & Grodno Governorates) (1 145k to 3 195k in 1897AD to 3 940k in 1914AD), Region 12 (Minsk Governorate & Pripyat Polesia) (920k to 2 148k to 3 040k), and Region 13 (Vitebsk & Mogilev Governorates, including the Catholic Latgalian *uezds* of Dvinsk, Rezhitsa, and Lyutsin) (1 245k to 3 176k to 4 020k) formed the classic *shtetl* (*mestechko*) heartland of the Pale [11][14][55]. After Alexander III's May Laws of 3 May 1882AD barred new Jewish rural residence and leases, Jewish populations (8-17,5% provincial shares) exceeded 50-65% inside Vilna (5k to 204,3k), the Bialystok woollen-textile boomtown (0k to 91,5k, site of the June 1906AD pogrom), Dvinsk/Daugavpils (7k to 112,8k), Minsk (9k to 117,6k), Vitebsk (9k to 108,9k), Gomel (8k to 104,5k), Grodno (9k to 61,6k), and Brest-Litovsk (6k to 57,4k, burned and evacuated to 16,5k in August 1915AD) [13][56]. Between 1906AD and 1914AD, overcrowded Belarusian villages in Mogilev, Vitebsk, and Minsk also sent over 340k peasant settlers to Siberia [57], while the 1915AD front line split Region 11 (3 940k to 2 880k, -26,9%) from rear-echelon Stavka headquarters Mogilev [6].

Bessarabia, the Southwestern Krai, and Transatlantic Emigration (Regions 16-19)

Annexed from the Ottoman Principality of Moldavia by the Treaty of Bucharest (1812AD), Bessarabia Governorate (Region 16, 47 379 km2) expanded nearly sevenfold from 385k in 1815AD to 950k in 1858AD, 1 935k in 1897AD, and 2 660k in 1914AD (2 620k in 1917AD), propelled by state-sponsored Bulgarian, Gagauz, German, Ukrainian, and Russian settlement across the southern Budjak steppe alongside a Moldovan rural majority and fast-growing Kishinev/Chisinau (14,5k -> 108,5k in 1897AD -> 128,7k in 1914AD), Bender (31,8k), Akkerman (28,3k), and Ismail (22,3k) [4][58][59]. Southern Bessarabia (Cahul, Bolgrad, and Ismail uezds) was ceded to Moldavia/Romania under the 1856AD Treaty of Paris and re-annexed by Russia at the 1878AD Congress of Berlin; in April 1903AD, the Kishinev Pogrom (49 killed), followed by the October 1905AD pogrom wave (Odessa, Kyiv, Bialystok), triggered the peak 1903-1914AD surge of Russian-Jewish transatlantic emigration (~1,25M arrivals in the United States in 1903-1914AD out of ~2,0M total Pale emigrants in 1881-1914AD) [12][13][60].

In the Southwestern Krai (Regions 17-19: Volhynia, Podolia, and Kyiv Governorates), abolition of Polish noble autonomy after 1831/1863AD and capital-intensive sugar-beet agro-industrialisation (accounting for over 80% of Imperial refined sugar output under the Brodsky, Tereshchenko, and Bobrinsky estates) supported Europe's densest black-earth rural populations [61][62]. Volhynia (Region 17) grew from 1 520k (1815AD) to 2 989k (1897AD) and 4 120k (1914AD) before 1915-1916AD Southwestern Front combat and the Russian Army's deportation of ~150k Volhynian Germans and border Jews lowered it to 3 680k (1917AD); Podolia (Region 18) rose from 1 440k to 3 018k (1897AD, 72,8 per km2) and 3 980k (1914AD); and Kyiv Governorate (Region 19) quintupled from 940k (1815AD) to 3 559k (1897AD) and 4 780k (1914AD -> 4 840k in 1917AD with wartime rear-area inflows), led by Kyiv (23,5k in 1815AD -> 247,7k in 1897AD -> 626,3k in 1914AD) [4][6].

Austro-Hungarian Galicia, Bukovina, and Subcarpathian Rus (Regions 14-15)

Across the Habsburg border, imperial abolition of *Robota* labour obligations during the Revolutions of 1848AD emancipated Ukrainian (*Ruthenian*) smallholders in Eastern Galicia (Region 14: 2 580k in 1815AD -> 3 360k in 1858AD -> 4 420k in 1897AD -> 5 020k in 1914AD) and Bukovina & Hungarian Subcarpathian Rus (Region 15: 770k -> 1 030k -> 1 400k -> 1 630k) [15][16][17]. Despite the turn-of-the-century Boryslav-Drohobych petroleum boom (Drohobych 36,5k, Boryslav 16,8k, making Galicia the world's third-largest oil producer in 1909AD) and the flowering of Lemberg/Lviv (44,5k -> 212,0k) and Czernowitz/Chernivtsi (7,2k -> 94,0k) [18][63], extreme dwarf-plot subdivision (>80% of peasant holdings under 5 ha) drove over 400k Galician, Bukovinian, and Transcarpathian Ukrainians and Jews to

homestead in Western Canada (Manitoba, Saskatchewan, Alberta) or enter American industrial towns between 1885AD and 1914AD. Between August 1914AD and 1917AD, four sweeping Russo-Austrian offensives across Galicia and the Carpathian passes, Austro-Hungarian military executions and internment of suspected Russophiles at Thalerhof (Graz), and Russian occupation deportations reduced Region 14 from 5 020k to 4 450k (-11,4%) and Region 15 from 1 630k to 1 500k (-8,0%) [6].

Region (10-19)	1815AD	1850AD	1870AD	1885AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
10. Kovno Gub.	660k	915k	1 120k	1 380k	1 545k	1 760k	1 840k	1 320k
11. Vilna & Grodno Gubs.	1 145k	1 560k	2 020k	2 680k	3 195k	3 780k	3 940k	2 880k
12. Minsk Gub. & Pripyat Polesia	920k	1 150k	1 420k	1 820k	2 148k	2 820k	3 040k	2 890k
13. Vitebsk & Mogilev Gubs.	1 245k	1 560k	1 980k	2 580k	3 176k	3 820k	4 020k	3 860k
14. Austro-Hungarian Eastern Galicia	2 580k	3 180k	3 680k	4 120k	4 420k	4 880k	5 020k	4 450k
15. Austro-Hungarian Bukovina	770k	970k	1 140k	1 290k	1 400k	1 570k	1 630k	1 500k
16. Bessarabia Gub.	385k	860k	1 160k	1 580k	1 935k	2 480k	2 660k	2 620k
17. Volhynia Gub.	1 520k	1 880k	2 240k	2 640k	2 989k	3 820k	4 120k	3 680k
18. Podolia Gub.	1 440k	1 840k	2 220k	2 650k	3 018k	3 740k	3 980k	3 820k
19. Kyiv Gub.	940k	1 580k	2 180k	2 920k	3 559k	4 520k	4 780k	4 840k

Table 4. Population series across Lithuania, Belarus, Austro-Hungarian Ukraine, Bessarabia, and Right-Bank Ukraine in thousands (1815AD - 1917AD).

Novorossiya, the Heartland, the 1891-1892AD Famine, and the Caucasus (Regions 20-40)

Crimean War, New Russia Coal-Steel Miracle, and Agrarian Heartland (Regions 20-35, 39-40)

Across the southern Ukrainian and Pontic-Azov steppes, demographic growth combined agrarian colonisation with late-Imperial heavy industrialisation:

Left-Bank *Malorossiya* and Sloboda Ukraine (Regions 20-21): Chernigov & Poltava (Region 20: 3 350k to 5 076k in 1897AD to 6 650k in 1914AD) suffered acute post-1861AD allotment shrinkage and became the Empire's No. 1 peasant donor zone to Siberia and the Far East [27], whereas Kharkov Governorate (Region 21: 1 100k to 2 492k to 3 440k) boomed around Kharkov (8k to 174,0k to 258,0k), locomotive works, and southern rail administration [62][64]. Novorossiya and the Don Cossack Host (Regions 22-24, 35): In Taurida Governorate (Region 24), the Crimean War (1853-1856AD) besieged and depopulated Sevastopol (0k in 1833AD to 11,2k in 1858AD) and triggered the 1860-1862AD Crimean Tatar and Nogai exodus (~180k-200k *muhajirs* emigrating to the Ottoman Empire, visibly flattening Region 24 from 640k in 1850AD to 660k in 1858AD), before mainland Tavria grain farming and naval reconstruction lifted Taurida to 1 448k (1897AD) and 2 060k (1914AD) [40][65][66]. To the north and west, Kherson Governorate (Region 22: 620k to 2 734k to 3 750k, led by grain-export metropolis Odessa 35,0k to 403,8k to 630,0k and shipyard Nikolaev 108,8k) [21][67], Ekaterinoslav Governorate (Region 23: 820k to 2 114k to 3 450k), and the Don Cossack

Host (Region 35: 680k to 2 564k to 3 880k, led by Rostov-on-Don 204,8k and Taganrog 78,6k) experienced Europe's fastest heavy-industrial transformation after the Catherine Railway (1884AD) linked Krivoy Rog hematite iron ore with Donbas coking coal around John Hughes's Yuzovka/Donetsk (9k in 1870AD to 28,1k in 1897AD to 54,0k in 1914AD), Ekaterinoslav (4k), Lugansk (0k), and Mariupol (0k) [20][68][69][70][71][72].

Capitals, Central Industrial Ring, Black-Earth Crisis & 1891-1892AD Famine (Regions 25-34, 39-40): While Saint Petersburg Governorate (Region 25: 760k to 2 112k to 3 150k in 1914AD to 3 380k in 1917AD; city 2,12M to 2,30M with wartime Putilov munitions expansion) and Moscow Governorate (Region 28: 1 120k to 2 431k to 3 560k to 3 820k; city 1,76M to 1,85M) absorbed millions of peasant *otkhodniki* from Novgorod-Pskov-Olonets (Region 26), Arkhangelsk-Vologda (Region 27, where Romanov-on-Murman/Murmansk was founded at the terminus of the Murman Railway in 1916AD), and the Central Industrial Ring (Region 29: 6 750k to 11 520k, including textile boomtown Ivanovo-Voznesensk 146,0k) [3][73][74], the Central Black-Earth (Regions 30-31) and Middle/Lower Volga (Regions 32-34) suffered recurrent Malthusian and epidemic shocks. Following severe autumn-spring drought across seventeen chernozem and Volga provinces, the 1891-1892AD Famine and Cholera Pandemic caused ~400k-500k excess deaths (compounded by typhus and the 1892AD Caspian-Volga cholera wave striking Astrakhan, Saratov, Samara, Simbirsk, Kazan, Voronezh, and Tambov) [19][75][76][77]. Combined with accelerating peasant out-migration, net population in Western Black-Earth (Region 30: Kursk, Oryol, Tula) and Eastern Black-Earth (Region 31: Voronezh, Tambov, Ryazan) actually contracted between 1885AD and the 1897AD Census (6 420k to 6 207k and 7 280k to 7 037k) before recovering to 7 980k and 9 220k by 1914AD [78][79][80]. Farther east, Samara & Saratov (Region 33: 1 580k to 5 157k to 6 880k, home to >400k Volga Germans and grain ports Saratov 235,9k, Samara 143,8k, and Tsaritsyn 101,0k), Perm & Vyatka (Region 39: 1 920k to 6 025k to 7 880k, Ekaterinburg 70,0k and Izhevsk arsenal), and Ufa & Orenburg (Region 40: 1 400k to 3 797k to 5 350k, Chelyabinsk 70,5k Trans-Siberian migration gateway) sustained rapid colonisation [81][82][83][84].

The Caucasian War and the 1864AD Circassian *Muhajir* Crisis (Regions 36-38)

Across the North Caucasus (261 835 km2, Regions 36-38), nineteenth-century demography was bifurcated by the Caucasian War (1817-1864AD). In the east, three decades of mountain warfare against Imam Shamil's Caucasian Imamate (1829-1859AD, ending at Gunib) depressed Dagestan Oblast (Region 38) from 450k (1815AD) to 410k (1858AD) before railway-port links through Petrovsk-Port/Makhachkala (24,8k) and Derbent (32,7k) restored growth to 571k (1897AD) and 715k (1914AD) [24][26][85]. In the northwest, the final conquest of Circassia (1860-1864AD, culminating at Kbaada in May 1864AD) entailed the systematic expulsion and Black Sea embarkation mortality of ~500k-650k+ Circassians (Adyghe), Ubykhs, and Abazas (*muhajirstvo*) to the Ottoman Empire [23][25]. Immediately thereafter, land grants to Kuban Cossacks and land-hungry Ukrainian and Russian *inogorodnie* peasants propelled Kuban Oblast & Black Sea Governorate (Region 36) nearly fivefold from 640k (1858AD) to 1 976k (1897AD) and 3 060k (1914AD, anchored by Ekaterinodar 107,1k and cement-grain port Novorossiysk 66,7k), while Stavropol & Terek (Region 37) surged from 860k (1858AD) to 1 807k (1897AD) and 2 610k (1914AD), driven by Vladikavkaz (79,3k) and the Grozny petroleum boom (15,6k -> 38,2k -> 45,0k in 1917AD) [86][87][88].

Region (20-40)	1815AD	1850AD	1870AD	1885AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
20. Little Russian Gubs.: Chernigov & Poltava	3 350k	4 120k	4 620k	4 880k	5 076k	6 280k	6 650k	6 720k
21. Kharkov Gub.	1 100k	1 480k	1 820k	2 180k	2 492k	3 220k	3 440k	3 510k
22. Kherson Gub.	620k	1 220k	1 680k	2 240k	2 734k	3 480k	3 750k	3 780k
23. Ekaterinoslav Gub.	820k	1 320k	1 680k	1 920k	2 114k	3 060k	3 450k	3 580k
24. Taurida Gub.	370k	640k	780k	1 080k	1 448k	1 880k	2 060k	2 080k

(Continued from previous page)

Region (20-40)	1815AD	1850AD	1870AD	1885AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
25. Saint Petersburg Gub.	760k	1 120k	1 420k	1 760k	2 112k	2 860k	3 150k	3 380k
26. Novgorod, Pskov & Olonets Gubs.	1 770k	2 160k	2 440k	2 680k	2 853k	3 380k	3 580k	3 680k
27. Arkhangelsk & Vologda Gubs.	920k	1 180k	1 360k	1 540k	1 688k	2 080k	2 220k	2 280k
28. Moscow Gub.	1 120k	1 520k	1 820k	2 140k	2 431k	3 220k	3 560k	3 820k
29. Central Industrial Ring: Vladimir, Yaroslavl, Kostroma, Tver, Smolensk & Kaluga Gubs.	6 750k	7 820k	8 450k	8 820k	9 160k	10 850k	11 520k	11 880k
30. Western Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Kursk, Oryol & Tula	4 520k	5 620k	6 220k	6 420k	6 207k	7 520k	7 980k	8 180k
31. Eastern Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Voronezh, Tambov & Ryazan	5 120k	6 420k	7 120k	7 280k	7 037k	8 680k	9 220k	9 450k
32. Middle Volga Gubs.: Nizhny Novgorod, Kazan, Simbirsk & Penza	4 280k	5 420k	6 120k	6 520k	6 755k	7 920k	8 350k	8 550k
33. Samara & Saratov Gubs.	1 580k	2 960k	3 980k	4 680k	5 157k	6 420k	6 880k	7 120k
34. Astrakhan Gub.	380k	580k	740k	880k	1 004k	1 280k	1 380k	1 410k
35. Don Cossack Host	680k	1 220k	1 680k	2 120k	2 564k	3 520k	3 880k	3 940k
36. Kuban Oblast & Black Sea Gub.	420k	580k	860k	1 380k	1 976k	2 760k	3 060k	3 120k
37. Stavropol Gub. & Terek Oblast	545k	780k	1 120k	1 480k	1 807k	2 380k	2 610k	2 650k
38. Dagestan Oblast	450k	420k	470k	530k	571k	680k	715k	725k
39. Perm & Vyatka Gubs.	1 920k	3 020k	4 180k	5 180k	6 025k	7 380k	7 880k	8 040k
40. Ufa & Orenburg Gubs.	1 400k	2 280k	2 980k	3 420k	3 797k	4 920k	5 350k	5 480k

Table 5. Population series across Left-Bank and Southern Ukraine, European Russia, the Volga, the North Caucasus, and the Urals in thousands (1815AD - 1917AD).

Siberia and the Far East: Rail vs River Partition & Priamurye (Regions 41-48)

Across the 13 354 849 km2 expanse of Siberia and the Russian Far East (Regions 41-48), aggregate population expanded more than sevenfold from 1 716k in 1815AD to 3 080k in 1858AD, 6 677k in 1897AD, 12 470k in 1914AD, and 12 875k in 1917AD [27][28][29][89]. As visualised in Figure 3A and quantified in Table 6, this colonization was sharply bifurcated between the Trans-Siberian Railway and Priamurye agricultural corridors (Regions 41, 43, 45, 48) and the northern riverine, gold-mining, and indigenous *yasak* basins (Regions 42, 44, 46, 47):

The Trans-Siberian Railway (1891-1916AD) and Stolypin Peasant Migration (1906-1914AD, Regions 41, 43, 45), initiated simultaneously at Vladivostok and Chelyabinsk in 1891AD and reinforced after 1906AD by

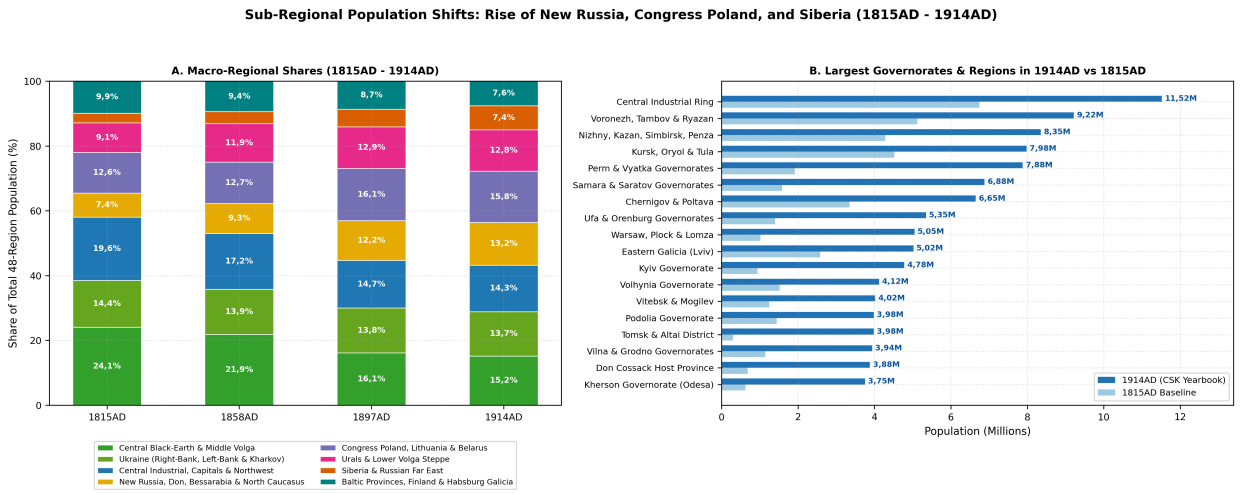


Figure 3. Trans-Siberian railway versus northern river basin growth in Siberia (Panel A) and wartime population shifts from 1914AD to 1917AD (Panel B).

Prime Minister P. A. Stolypin's Resettlement Administration (*Pereselencheskoe upravlenie*, offering cheap *khutor*/*otrub* land credits, agronomic depots, and subsidized fourth-class rail cars), peasant migration across the Urals exceeded 5,0M gross (>3,5M net) settlers between 1896AD and 1914AD, peaking in 1907-1909AD (665k-759k migrants per year) [27][28][90][91]. Region 43 (Tomsk Railway Trunk & Altai Imperial Cabinet Lands) was the No. 1 Stolypin magnet in the entire Empire, surging nearly fourteenfold from 300k (1815AD) to 1 928k (1897AD), 3 980k (1914AD), and 4 180k (1917AD) as settlers poured onto fertile chernozem leased from the Tsar's Cabinet around Barnaul (1k to 61,0k), Biysk (5k), and the Ob bridge rail boomtown of Novonikolaevsk/Novosibirsk (founded 1893AD; 7,8k in 1897AD to 85,0k in 1914AD to 107,0k in 1917AD), overtaking university seat Tomsk (7k) [90][92]. Similarly, Region 41 (Southern Tobolsk & Omsk Trans-Siberian Belt) grew from 545k (1815AD) to 1 740k (1897AD) and 3 180k (1914AD, led by Omsk 37,4k to 135,8k and Danish-cooperative butter hub Kurgan 38,5k) [93][94][95], and Region 45 (Central Trans-Siberian Corridor) rose from 210k to 1 540k (Krasnoyarsk 87,5k, Irkutsk 129,7k) [96].

Bypassed River Trails, the 1912AD Lena Goldfields, and 1914AD Uriankhai (Regions 42, 44, 46, 47): By contrast, Region 42 (Ob-Irtysh River North: Tobolsk, Berezov, Surgut, Obdorsk, Narym) grew modestly (160k to 375k to 505k), with old guberniya capital Tobolsk stagnating at 20,4k to 24,5k once bypassed 250 km to the south by the railway. Region 44 (Altai-Sayan Highlands & Uriankhai) rose from 125k to 565k (1914AD), incorporating Minusinsk settlers, Altai pastoralists [97], and the Uriankhai Krai (Tuva) placed under formal Imperial Russian protectorate in April 1914AD with its new administrative post at Belotsarsk (Kyzyl). Region 46 (Yenisei-Turukhansk Polar North & Lena Goldfields) (68k to 195k to 270k) combined stagnating river-town Yeniseysk (5k to 11,9k) with the remote Vitim-Olekma placer camps around Bodaibo (8k), where troops shot >200 striking Lena Goldfields (Lenzoloto) miners on 4 April 1912AD. Region 47 (Transbaikal & Yakutsk Oblasts) (278k to 942k to 1 295k) united Buryat and Sakha (*Yakut*) pastoralists (~225k Yakuts and ~180k Transbaikal Buryats in 1897AD), Nerchinsk *katorga* mines, Yakutsk (8k), and railway junction Chita (5k to 79,2k) [89][98].

1858-1860AD Priamurye Annexation and Sakhalin (Region 48), acquired from Qing China via Governor-General N. N. Muravyov-Amursky's Treaty of Aigun (1858AD) and N. P. Ignatyev's Convention of Peking (1860AD), the Priamurye Governor-Generalship (Amur, Primorskaya, and Sakhalin, 1 043 120 km2) soared nearly fortyfold from 30k indigenous Tungusic/Nivkh inhabitants (1815AD) and 55k (1858AD) to

372k (1897AD) and 1 135k (1914AD to 1 150k in 1917AD) [30][99]. Growth was driven by Amur and Ussuri Cossacks, >250k Ukrainian peasants from Poltava, Chernigov, and Kyiv sailing via Odessa Volunteer Fleet (*Dobroflot*) steamers and the Chinese Eastern (1903AD) and Amur (1916AD) Railways into the Ussuri "Green Wedge" (*Zelenyy Klyn* around Nikolsk-Ussuriysky 47,4k), Vladivostok (5k to 108,0k wartime Allied supply port), Blagoveshchensk (5k), and Khabarovsk (3k). On Sakhalin, secured wholly in exchange for the Kurils under the 1875AD Treaty of Saint Petersburg (1k penal exiles and guards in 1897AD centred on Aleksandrovsky Post), defeat in the Russo-Japanese War (1904-1905AD) forced the cession of Southern Sakhalin (Karafuto, south of 50°N) under the September 1905AD Treaty of Portsmouth [30].

Region (41-48)	1815AD	1850AD	1858AD	1870AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
41. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Belt: Southern Tobolsk	545k	880k	990k	1 180k	1 740k	2 780k	3 180k	3 320k
42. Ob-Irtysh River Trail & Polar Tundra: Tobolsk, Surgut, Berezov & Narym	160k	220k	240k	275k	375k	465k	505k	520k
43. Tomsk Railway Trunk	300k	580k	690k	920k	1 928k	3 420k	3 980k	4 180k
44. Altai-Sayan Highlands: Gorny Altai, Minusinsk & Uriankhai Protectorate	125k	185k	205k	240k	330k	495k	565k	575k
45. Central Siberian Trans-Siberian Corridor: Achinsk-Krasnoyarsk-Kansk & Irkutsk	210k	330k	375k	460k	795k	1 320k	1 540k	1 560k
46. Yenisei-Turukhansk Polar North & Bodaibo Lena Goldfields	68k	98k	110k	135k	195k	245k	270k	265k
47. Transbaikal Oblast	278k	380k	415k	510k	942k	1 180k	1 295k	1 305k
48. Priamurye Gov.-Gen.: Amur, Primorskaya	30k	45k	55k	95k	372k	920k	1 135k	1 150k

Table 6. Population series across the eight Siberian and Far Eastern regions in thousands, contrasting rail corridors and northern river basins (1815AD - 1917AD).

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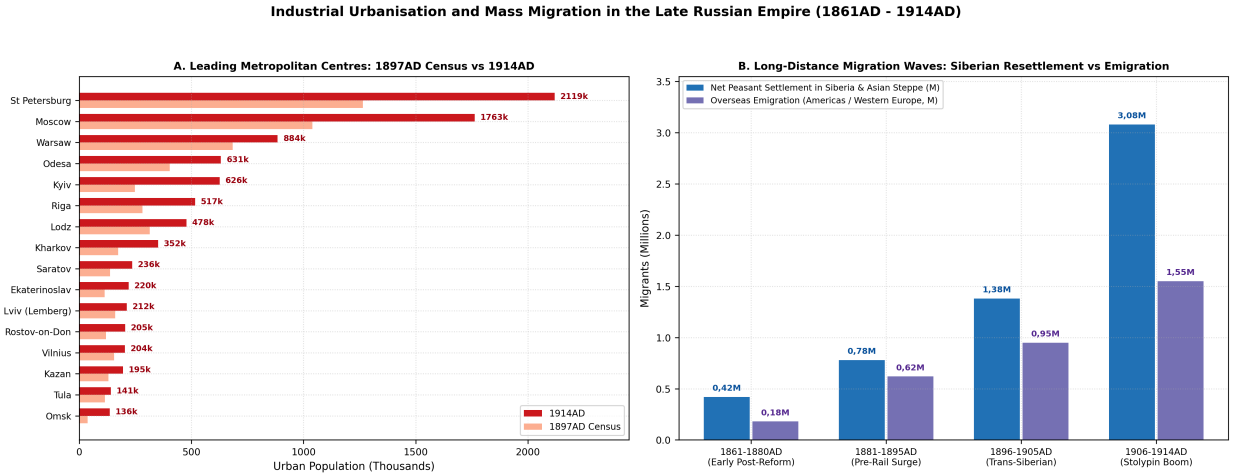


Figure 4. Largest Late Imperial cities in 1897AD and 1914AD (Panel A) and urban growth trajectories of major industrial, port, and rail hubs (1815AD - 1917AD, Panel B).

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